



Disappearing drives, overworked CPUs, OSs replacing other OSes. Oh! the horror...

Failing hard drives, malware troubles and slow SSDs never seem to deter the good folks from Team Digit and they come to the rescue of our readers to troubleshoot their digital lives

Q Ubuntu replaced Windows?

I'm quite new with Ubuntu and I'm not that good with computers at all. I was using Windows 7 but thought of trying out Ubuntu by installing it alongside Windows and using dual boot. Before installing Ubuntu via a USB drive, it provides you with an option for testing it first. However, I accidentally started the installation of the operating system without giving any directory or paths. After which, my entire data on the partitions "C:" and "D:" were deleted. The computer is now running on Ubuntu at the moment from the connected USB drive. Now, instead of showing "C:" and "D:", Ubuntu shows one partition with the entire capacity of the computer. I had no idea that this kind of a thing would happen and so I never performed a backup of my data stored on the drive before installing Ubuntu. My question is that, can I get back my lost data as it's very important for me. I've also refrained from overwriting any new data on the drive in the hope that I can recover the old data. Please help. Thank you in advance.

—Emo Ete

A It's good that you didn't overwrite data on the drive. For recovering accidentally replaced or overwritten partitions, you can use TestDisk for Ubuntu. TestDisk is a partition scanner and disk recovery tool which checks the partition and boot sectors of drives and is very useful in recovering lost partitions. To use TestDisk, follow these steps:

- First boot, into the Live session of Ubuntu as you normally do using the connected USB drive.

- Download and install TestDisk to the live session using the software center or by heading to this link: dgit.in/TestDisk1.
- Next, head to this link: dgit.in/TSteps and find a step-by-step guide to using TestDisk to recover data.
- Once you're done with the above process, you should've recovered your accidentally deleted data. Be prepared and careful the next time.

Q CPU under load

My system's specifications are:

- Intel Core-i5 2320;
- Gigabyte motherboard;
- 4GB Kingston HyperX RAM;
- 1TB HDD;
- NVIDIA GeForce GT 640 GPU;

I recently installed a lot of important software that I downloaded off the internet. But the problem is that I see my CPU always under heavy load, even when it's completely idle. Is it because of some newly installed program? Can you help me to understand what's eating up my CPU?

—Pratik Jaiswal

A Heavy CPU utilisation is usually a sign of malware. Since you've recently installed many new programs, it's quite possible that a malware or two might have crept in and infected your system. Make sure you have an antivirus software installed and then run a full system scan. Next download and install Malwarebytes from malwarebytes.com and run it to get rid of malwares if any. You can also start the Task Manager to see the running processes and check which process is eating CPU usage.

Q Disappearing Hard Drive

I have an internal Seagate 500GB Hard Disk Drive in my desktop which I use for secondary storage. It was working fine from a long time and didn't give me any trouble whatsoever. But recently, I discovered that the the drive isn't visible in my computer. What can be the reason for this? I have a lot of data on the drive. Please help.

—Ramesh

A Since the drive was previously visible in the explorer, the first step here would be to check and see whether the drive shows up in the BIOS. Do the same while booting up your system and going into the BIOS. If it doesn't show up in the BIOS, then you'll have to open your desktop's cabinet and check the drive's SATA or power cables and tighten them. If the drive shows up after that, you'll



Click on the "Check Now" button

have to run CHKDSK on it by right-clicking the drive in the explorer and choosing Properties > Tools > "Check now" and "Automatically fix file systems errors". If for some reason the drive still isn't visible in your